PRACTITIONER REFERENCE

Massage Contraindication Chart

A quick screen, not a diagnosis.
When in doubt, wait or refer.

KEY **No** Don't provide **Wait** Postpone **Refer** Clearance first **Local** Avoid the area *Caution* Modify OK Proceed

IF CLIENT HAS	Swedish	Deep/Sports	Prenatal	Hot stone	Cupping	Lymphatic
ILLNESS, SKIN & INJURY						
Fever or acute illness [1]	Wait	Wait	Wait	Wait	Wait	Wait
Contagious skin condition [2]	No	No	No	No	No	No
Acute injury <72 h [3]	Local	Local	Local	Local	Local	Local
Sunburn, wound, new tattoo [4]	Local	Local	Local	Local	Local	Local
Recent Botox or fillers [5]	Local	Local	Local	Local	Local	Local
Varicose veins [6]	Local	Local	Local	Local	Local	*Caution*
CIRCULATION, HEART & ORGANS						
Suspected DVT or clot [7]	No	No	No	No	No	No
History of DVT [8]	Refer	Refer	Refer	Refer	Refer	Refer
Blood thinners or bleeding [9]	*Caution*	No	Refer	*Caution*	No	Refer
Uncontrolled high BP [10]	Refer	Refer	Refer	No	Refer	Refer
Heart condition or CHF [11]	Refer	Refer	Refer	No	Refer	No
Kidney disease [12]	Refer	Refer	Refer	Refer	Refer	No
MEDICAL & PROCEDURES						
Recent surgery <6 weeks [13]	Refer	Refer	Refer	Refer	Wait	Refer
Cosmetic surgery (lipo, BBL) [14]	Refer	No	Refer	No	No	Refer
Active cancer [15]	Refer	Refer	Refer	Refer	No	Refer
Osteoporosis [16]	*Caution*	No	*Caution*	*Caution*	*Caution*	OK
Diabetes or neuropathy [17]	*Caution*	*Caution*	Refer	No	*Caution*	*Caution*
Pregnancy: 1st tri, high-risk [18]	Refer	No	Refer	No	No	Refer
Implanted device [19]	Local	Local	Local	Local	No	Local
SESSION & CONSENT						
Intoxication [20]	No	No	No	No	No	No
Minor without guardian [21]	No	No	No	No	No	No

[1] Reschedule once well and fever-free [24] h.
[2] No session until resolved or cleared.
[3] Avoid the area 48–72 h; no heat on it.
[4] Work around it; new tattoos [2–4] weeks.
[5] Avoid treated areas for [24 h–2 weeks].
[6] No pressure or cups directly over veins.
[7] Calf swollen, red, warm, painful: urgent care.
[8] Physician clearance; light pressure on legs.
[9] Lighter pressure only; no deep work or cups.
[10] Physician input first; no heat. Rise slowly.
[11] Physician input first. CHF: no lymphatic work.
[12] Physician input. Kidney failure: no lymphatic.
[13] Physician clearance; avoid the incision area.
[14] Surgeon clearance and specific training.
[15] Oncologist input; avoid tumor, radiation sites.
[16] Gentle pressure; no cups over bony areas.
[17] Less sensation: lighter, no heat; skip injection sites.
[18] [Many start after 1st trimester.] High-risk: clearance.
[19] Pacemaker, port, pump: avoid the area.
[20] End the session [charged per policy].
[21] Guardian consent and present [policy].

Conservative defaults; check your state board rules. Physician advice and state rules come first. When unsure, refer.